

calendars, as on orkut and Meetup. On some sites, the creation of a commercial community forum is forbidden and can result in a user ban.

Most community forums on social networking sites (e.g. orkut and Tribe) employ some threaded display methods, where topics are initialized by a certain user and replied to by others. One of the important things to note regarding communities is that they can be used to enhance the software that they are running on. An administration discussion forum can raise useful suggestions or bug reports that can increase the usability of the underlying software.

Internet Relay Chat (IRC) has long been used by communities to host real-time discussion of various topics. With the advent of metadata storage and searching of chat conversation logs, and the use of Java-based applets to offer IRC functionality on the Web, chat collaboration features are being incorporated into social networking sites.

The wiki is another method for community collaboration that has yet to feature on most social networking sites. Wiki, derived from the Hawaiian word for quick, allows a community open read and write access to a database of pages, even if a user is not the originator of the material being edited. This flexibility can either be highly successful in a healthy busy community or disastrous in an indifferent community where anonymous users can make unwanted changes to a wiki set. However, wikis normally employ a version control system so that rollback to a previous version can be employed, and in a busy community any deleted pages will normally reappear if they are important.

Real World Events

Event listings are a major feature of social networking sites. These are usually either linked to an entire site as a general meeting for all members, or to a particular community with events listed beside a particular discussion forum. Some sites such as Meetup focus almost exclusively on arranging meetings for particular